

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
 ♥ 9 5 3 2
 ♦ A Q J 10 4
 ♣ Q 9 8

♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ —

♣ K J 10 2



♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	7 ♠
All Pass			
7 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

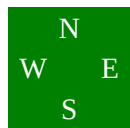
Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4 3
 ♥ K Q 8 7 2
 ♦ J
 ♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ 4
 ♦ A K 10 8 6 3
 ♣ A K Q



♠ J 9 6 2
 ♥ J 9 5 3
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ 4 3 2

♠ K 8 7
 ♥ A 10 6
 ♦ Q 9 7 4
 ♣ J 10 8

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♥K			

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 7 4 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 9 6 2

♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A K Q 6



♠ A K J 6 5 2

♥ 5

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 7 5

♠ —

♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ 10

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ Q 4 3
 ♦ Q J 7 5 2
 ♣ Q J 8 3

♠ K 10 7 2
 ♥ A K 8 6 5
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ 6 4



♠ 9
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ 10 9 7 5 2

♠ A Q J 8 5 4 3
 ♥ 7
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♦	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			

Your 2♥ response shows 8+ points, with at least 5 ♥s.

Your hand is looking better and better. You already gave a positive response so you know you are forced to game. It is better to keep the bidding low to allow more investigating room so you bid 3♠. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

With ♠s agreed as trumps you have two Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♥A. With no trump Queen you respond 5♥. Partner now says 5NT. What do you reply?

Partner is asking for Kings and you have just 1, the ♥K. Remember, the ♠K is not a King, it is a Key-Card which you have already counted. So you bid 6♦. Partner counts 13 tricks and bids 7NT.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ 10 7 5 3
 ♦ 9 5 3
 ♣ A Q 10 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3

♥ A 8

♦ 10 8 6 4

♣ K J 5



♠ 8 2

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 8 4 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ K Q J 2

♣ —

West	North	East	South
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Pass	3♠	Pass	1♠
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Pass	4♥	Pass	6♠
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All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♦ 3

Partner's 3♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points and good ♠ support.

What you DO NOT say next is 4NT. If partner answered 1 Key-Card you would not know what to do. If he has a red Ace you can make slam, but if his one Key-Card were the ♣A you couldn't. Instead you make a control-showing bid of 4♣, promising first round control. Partner obliges you by bidding 4♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bidding is like the Sherlock Holmes tale Silver Blaze, about the dog that didn't bark. Partner's ♥ bid shows that he **DOES** have the ♥A, but equally important it shows that he **DOES NOT** have the ♦A. So you know you don't have a ♥ loser but do have a ♦ loser. You bid 6♠.